address migration issues on the global scale. The so-called Global Compact on Migration, agreed at UN level in 2016, solves little.

In the Central European tier of Eastern Europe, which is already for some time a part of the European Union, the political debate in the future will surely centre around foreign policy, energy mix, response to climate change, and access to and aims of EU funds, but also about fundamentals, like European values, including, of course, the rule of law. This discussion is essential, though it is not an exercise solely needed in the Eastern part of the continent.

The op-ed by Mateusz Morawiecki, the Polish Prime Minister from August 2022,[250] six months into the war in Ukraine, provides an interesting example of such discussion. The Polish leader takes the ongoing war in Ukraine as his point of departure, saying that it 'has exposed the truth about Russia' and about the 'imperialist tendencies' of Putin's state, but also the truth about Europe, whose many leaders 'allowed themselves to be lured by Vladimir Putin'. However, in the Polish Prime Minister's confident view, this is not because Europe 'was insufficiently integrated, but because it refused to listen to the voice […] coming from Poland' which is 'in matters of relations with Russia […] simply far more experienced than others'. He continues that this ignorance of Poland is just an example of the broader problem of the equality of individual countries in the EU: 'Political practice has shown that the voice of Germany and France counts above all. […] In addition, the strong ones make mistakes and are incapable of accepting criticism from outside.' He advocates for preservation of the principle of unanimity in the EU, and to make the case against abolishing this principle he – probably rather unfortunately from the point of view of Berlin – gives the example of Germany, saying that '[i]f all of Europe would have followed Germany's voice, not only Nord Stream 1, but also Nord Stream 2 would have been launched for many months'. Furthermore and returning to the argument of migration, had this principle been abandoned '[w]e would be an object rather than a subject of international politics today if the European Union, instead of a tough policy of defending its own borders – a fundamental attribute of state sovereignty – had also adopted the rules for distribution of migrants proposed in 2015. Back then, Putin noticed that migrants could be used as a tool in a hybrid war against the EU […] Our resilience to the next big crisis would be even lower today if we had